

13.1 - The Singularity and The Future

Artificial Intelligence Policy

Prof. Jack Reilly

S2026

Think:

- *What does the future hold? Is there an AI Singularity on the horizon?*
- *Are current AI paradigms, products, and tools sufficient to bring about substantial technological and societal change? Do we need a new paradigm for AI to continue to advance? Is there another AI winter on the horizon without substantial new scientific and technological invention?*
- *Is AI a greater or lesser existential risk than other threats (nuclear, climate, disease, etc) facing humanity? Or is AI not really about threat at all, and more about promise? Can we build a better future for us all with technology?*

Read:

- Bili-Hamelin et al, 2025. [“Stop Treating AGI as the North Star of AI research”](#)

Watch:

- Mitchell, 2025. [“The Past, Present, and Uncertain Future of AI”](#)

Listen:

- *Optional:* Complexity* podcast, Season 2, Episode 6: [“AI’s Changing Seasons”](#)

Browse:

new FB guy venture - Wait But Why (Urban), 2015. “The AI Revolution: The Road to Superintelligence” - [Part 1](#) - [Part 2](#) - “AI 2027” - See also: [The AI 2027 scenario and what it means: a video tour](#)*

Additional Resources:

- Kurzweil, *The Singularity is Near* and *The Singularity is Nearer*
- Altman, 2025. “[The Gentle Singularity](#)”
- Shojaei, 2025. “The Illusion of Thinking: Understanding the Strengths and Limitations of Reasoning Models via the Lens of Problem Complexity(<https://machinelearning.apple.com/research/illusion-of-thinking>)” Apple.
 - *See also:* Marcus, 2025. “[Seven replies to the viral Apple reasoning paper – and why they fall short](#)”

Submit:

- Discussion question to course chat

 Tip

- “ Read”, “ Listen”, and/or “ Watch” items are required content for the day, and should be read/heard/watched before class on that day.
- “ Browse” items should be briefly looked at but do not need to be read deeply unless you want to
- “ Additional Resources” do not need to be looked at; they are there to serve, if useful, as further references for your debates, final projects, and general edification later.